

|| BHAYANAKA ||

The fear and anxiety...

In the wake of recent mishappenings, proper disaster management measures taken in all future constructions are the need of the hour.

The boom in the realty sector has led to an unparalleled growth of multi-story buildings and townships. Considering the fact that most of our cities are already facing problems with the established infrastructure, it is important that constructions are carried out in a planned and scientific manner.

Most buildings are not built as per building bylaws. Faulty designs and constructions make them vulnerable to damages that can be caused through earthquake. In addition, many buildings are not equipped with the requisite fire-safety arrangements. Delhi and its adjoining areas, where real estate business is flourishing fast, fall under seismic zone IV and are quite prone to earthquakes. In the absence of planned construction and safety measures, one can well imagine how much threat these high-rises can possess to the life of inhabitants.

Even the haphazard growth has put an immense pressure on the existing water disposal and drainage system in the cities. The torrential rains are enough to bring this problem to the fore. Metros like Mumbai and Kolkata are brought to a halt by the incessant rains every year.

Since all the major cities of India are passing through an infrastructural development phase, proper planning is necessary. Even for the real estate developers, who are building residential and commercial properties and

establishing new integrated townships, it is important that all the structural mitigation measures are well taken care of.

Building bylaws ensure technical implementation of the safety aspects in all new constructions. Therefore, engineers and architects need to strictly adhere to building bylaws and come up with seismically safe designs and constructions. The tall structures should be able to withstand the earthquake tremors. These buildings should even have fire-safety measures installed to avoid any mishap.

Upcoming modern townships need to be well equipped with all the facilities. Proper storm water drainage system, provision for easy availability of basic amenities, including regular water and electricity supply, should be there. In addition, systematic disaster management planning should go hand in hand in establishing these townships.

Many real estate developers are building their townships within the purview of existing town and country planning acts. Their buildings are even carrying all the required safety measures. But the fact remains that constructive planning has to become a part of all future constructions, including both — building apartments and townships.



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(M) 9891929364, 987114502

Delhi: 011-46565656, Gurgaon: 0124-4636363

email: marketing@jmdgroup.in. Website: www.jmdgroup.in

